Vallinayagam were being intercepted under the category of 'revolutionaries'.[47]

It is in late March 1911 that we next hear of SSNCo. On 28 March, the police reported that the *Gallia* was sold by auction at Colombo to one C.W. Mackie for Rs 27,500; but, as we note below, this transaction is not borne out by the Lloyd's Register of Shipping.[48] Even as the Swadeshi company was gasping for its last breath, the district collector could not hold himself from giving the following parting shot: '[the sale was] really to a syndicate. No one attended the meeting of the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company to wind up. Probably they were afraid of a further call for subscriptions. The company will now die a natural, if lingering, death.'[49] To describe premeditated garrotting as natural death could only be the product of a diabolical mind.

At about the same time, it was reported that SSNCo's headquarters in Tuticorin had moved from VOC's house on Sannadhi Street to one Sappani Achari's house in Keelur.[50] The earlier shifting of the office to VOC's home —we do not know when this happened or why—could not have been an auspicious sign in the first place. Probably everyone had given up, and the company could not even afford office space. The further removal of the office may have followed when VOC's wife Meenakshi and family moved out of Tuticorin. In any case, it is fitting that the company found a last refuge in the home of its founder.

In June, the steam launch *Miranda*, earlier made over (mortgaged) to S. Parthasarathy, was auctioned. Since the highest bid of Rs 5,500 made by one Ponniah Fernandez was considered too low, there was a re-auction three days later. But with no higher bid, the *Miranda* was sold to the same bidder at the same price.[51] The *Miranda*'s book value on 31 March 1908, we may recall, was Rs 24,784-7-8. Either the launch had been overvalued or had suffered subsequently due to lack of maintenance. Whatever the reason, this was undoubtedly a rock-bottom price.

What about the *Lawoe* and the *Gallia*?